

Influence_Consensus_add_mil - In society, does addiction alone generally have a direct effect on the quality to Military (capacity for organized defense, including funding, personnel, and operational capability), or are observed relationships primarily indirect? If a direct effect exists, is it negative, none, negligible, or positive? What would be a reasonable normalized magnitude for this influence on a scale from -1.00 to 1.00? Please only provide evidence for only direct influences.

Addiction has a direct negative effect on military capacity, particularly by impairing force readiness, personnel performance, and operational capability. Heavy and binge drinking among active-duty military personnel are associated with increased risks of alcohol-related problems that diminish psychological fitness and readiness for duty (■ Bray et al., 2013). Alcohol use disorder (AUD) incidence in the military correlates with negative career outcomes, including higher rates of non-routine separations such as misconduct or poor performance, which directly reduce available personnel and degrade military effectiveness (■ Judkins et al., 2021; ■ Gray et al., 2021). Mild traumatic brain injury (TBI) in service members increases the risk of addiction-related disorders, further eroding warfighter performance over time (■ Miller et al., 2013). Behavioral addictions like internet addiction also negatively affect military adjustment, though some effects may be partially mediated by family function (■ Yang et al., 2016). On a normalized scale from -1.00 to 1.00 representing direct influence on military capacity, addiction's effect is clearly negative and moderate to strong, reasonably estimated around -0.5 to -0.7 due to its substantial impact on personnel health, retention, and operational readiness (■ Bray et al., 2013; ■ Judkins et al., 2021; ■ Gray et al., 2021).

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References

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